

"Not Interested" Recovery

Script - Skill: objections - Difficulty: intermediate - Est. 7 min

Draft resource pending human editorial review - not yet professionally verified.

A calm response to a reflex "not interested" that acknowledges it, asks one honest question to learn what is behind it, and knows when the no is real enough to stop.

Learning objectives

- Acknowledge the objection without arguing
- Ask one question to understand the real reason
- Offer a small, relevant next step if there is interest
- Recognise a firm no and exit respectfully

The recovery in three moves

1. Acknowledge genuinely: "That is fair, thanks for being direct."
2. Ask one clarifying question to separate a reflex from a real no.
3. If a door opens, offer one small next step; if not, thank them and end.

Questions that respect the person

- "Is it the timing, or is this just not something you deal with?"
- "Fair enough - out of interest, is it a priority thing or a fit thing?"
- "Understood. Would it help if I checked back another time, or should I leave it?"

Worked example

Prospect: "Not interested." You: "That is fair, thanks for being direct. Can I ask - is it that the timing is off, or that this kind of thing is not a priority right now?"

Prospect: "Just not a priority this quarter." You: "Understood. I will not chase you - would a check-in next quarter be welcome, or would you rather I close this out?"

Safe-practice note

One honest question after a "not interested" is fair; a second push after a clear, repeated no is not. Never imply the prospect is making a mistake or use guilt to keep them talking. A firm no is a complete answer - thank them and end the call.

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